

ROYAL FITNESS CLUB

Nutrition & Healthy Eating Certificate

MODULE 4

Meal Planning for Different Goals

Duration	65 minutes
Course Code	CS_B2
Level	Beginner
Format	Study Guide PDF

Part of the Royal Fitness Club Professional Certification Program.

SECTION 1: The Foundation of Successful Meal Planning

Why Meal Planning Changes Everything

The number one predictor of dietary success is not willpower, motivation, or knowledge — it is preparation. People who plan their meals eat 30% fewer calories from processed foods, consume 50% more vegetables, and are twice as likely to maintain their goal weight. Meal planning removes decision fatigue from the most important health decision you make every day.

Meal Planning Benefit	Mechanism	Quantified Impact
Reduces decision fatigue	Choices made in advance without hunger	Reduces impulsive high-calorie choices by 30–50%
Saves money	Bulk buying; reduces restaurant/takeaway frequency	Average saving: █ 3000–8000/month for families
Ensures nutritional adequacy	Pre-planned variety ensures micronutrient balance	80+ plant foods/week achievable with planning
Supports training goals	Pre/post-workout meals timed appropriately	10–15% improvement in recovery metrics in planned vs unplanned dieters
Reduces food waste	Use only what's needed; use ingredients across multiple meals	25–40% reduction in household food waste

SECTION 2: Meal Plans for Fat Loss

Fat Loss Meal Planning Principles

Effective fat loss meal planning is built on five pillars:

- Caloric deficit: 300–500 kcal below TDEE (sustainable without muscle loss)
- High protein: 2.0–2.4g/kg body weight (preserves lean mass in deficit)
- High fibre: 25–38g/day (satiety without excessive calories)
- Low energy density: foods with high volume per calorie (vegetables, lean protein)
- Adequate fat: minimum 15–20% of calories (hormonal health)

Indian Fat Loss Day (75kg male, 1800 kcal target)

Meal	Food	Calories	P/C/F (grams)
Breakfast (8am)	3 eggs + 2 whole wheat bread slices + black coffee	380	27P / 32C / 14F
Mid-morning (11am)	1 apple + 200g low-fat Greek yoghurt	200	14P / 30C / 3F
Lunch (1pm)	150g chicken breast (grilled) + 1 cup brown rice + 2 cups sabzi (mixed veg curry) + salad	500	45P / 55C / 8F
Pre-workout (4pm)	1 banana + 30g whey protein in water	270	27P / 32C / 2F
Post-workout (7pm)	150g paneer bhurji (low oil) + 1 roti	320	24P / 25C / 12F
Dinner (8:30pm)	1 cup dal + salad + 100g tofu tikka (baked)	330	28P / 30C / 8F

TOTAL		2000 (approx)	165P / 204C / 47F
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Calorie-reducing strategies within Indian cuisine:

- Use air fryer or minimal oil cooking vs deep-frying (saves 100–300 kcal per dish)
- Replace full-fat coconut milk with light coconut milk or yoghurt in curries
- Use cauliflower rice (gobi chawal) 2–3 days/week to reduce caloric density of meals
- Dahi (curd) as base for marinades instead of cream-based sauces
- Increase sabzi (vegetable curry) portion and reduce grain portion to lower energy density

SECTION 3: Meal Plans for Muscle Building

Muscle Building Nutrition Strategy

Building muscle requires a caloric surplus (typically 200–400 kcal above TDEE), combined with high protein intake and adequate carbohydrates to fuel training and spare protein for tissue synthesis.

Key principle: In a caloric surplus with resistance training, roughly 30–50% of weight gained is muscle, 50–70% is fat (in a "dirty bulk"). A controlled "lean bulk" (+200 kcal/day) maximises muscle:fat gain ratio.

Indian Muscle Building Day (70kg male, 2800 kcal target)

Meal	Food	Calories	P/C/F
Breakfast (7:30am)	2 whole wheat paratha + whole milk lassi (250ml)	350	42P / 65C / 28F
Mid-morning (10:30am)	1 banana + 30g peanut butter + oats 50g	550	35P / 60C / 16F
Lunch (1pm)	200g chicken curry (home cooked) + 2 cups rice + 1 cup dal + 75g salad	750	55P / 80C / 18F
Pre-workout (4pm)	1 cup curd + 1 banana + handful dates (4–5)	300	10P / 60C / 4F
Post-workout (7pm)	30g whey + 50g oats	250	28P / 36C / 3F
Dinner (8:30pm)	200g salmon/fish curry + 1.5 cups rice + sabzi	680	48P / 70C / 18F
Pre-sleep (10:30pm)	300g cottage cheese (paneer) / casein shake	300	22P / 10C / 15F
TOTAL		2780	240P / 381C / 102F

SECTION 4: Meal Plans for Vegetarians and Vegans

Plant-Based Performance Nutrition

A well-planned plant-based diet can fully support athletic performance and muscle building. However, it requires intentional planning to address potential shortfalls: protein (quantity + quality), B12, iron, zinc, omega-3, iodine, and Vitamin D3.

Nutrient	Vegan Risk	Best Plant Sources	When to Supplement
B12	High (no plant sources)	Nutritional yeast, fortified cereals	250–500mcg cyanocobalamin daily
Iron (haem)	Moderate (only non-haem)	Dark leafy greens, lentils, chickpeas, pumpkin seeds, fortified cereals	<20mcg/mL; always with Vitamin C
Zinc	Moderate (phytate binding)	Legumes, hemp seeds, pumpkin seeds, cashews	Consider 15–25mg zinc if training heavily
Omega-3 (EPA/DHA)	High (ALA poorly converts)	Flaxseed, chia, walnuts, algae oil (EPA+DHA source)	Algae oil (EPA+DHA source) — 500–1000mg/day
Iodine	Moderate (no dairy/seafood)	Iodised salt, seaweed (dried)	Use iodine supplement if low intake
Calcium	Low-moderate	Fortified plant milk, ragi, sesame, tofu	250–500mg calcium if intake low
Vitamin D3	High (vegan D3 from lichen)	Fortified plant milk, mushrooms	2000–4000 IU vegan D3 daily

Vegan Protein Day Plan (65kg female, 2000 kcal, 130g protein target)

Meal	Food	Protein
Breakfast	Tofu scramble (150g firm tofu) + 2 whole wheat toast + edamame (50g)	38g
Snack	Soy protein shake + 30g peanut butter + 1 apple	30g
Lunch	Rajma chawal (kidney beans 100g dry) + brown rice + spinach salad with hemp seeds	32g
Pre-workout	Soy milk smoothie + banana + 20g pea protein	25g
Post-workout	Pea protein shake + rice cakes + peanut butter	22g
Dinner	Tempeh stir fry (150g) + quinoa + roasted vegetables	35g
TOTAL		~172g protein ✓

SECTION 5: Meal Prep Masterclass

Batch Cooking for the Week

The most effective meal planning strategy is Sunday batch cooking — preparing the bulk of the week's protein, grains, and vegetables in one 2–3 hour session, then assembling meals quickly throughout the week.

Component	Batch Cook Method	Refrigerator Life	Use In
Brown rice / quinoa	Cook 5 cups dry; store in containers	5 days	Lunch bowls, dinner sides, post-workout meals
Grilled chicken (600g)	Season, bake at 200°C 25–30 min	4 days	Wraps, salads, dinner protein

Hard-boiled eggs (12)	Boil 10–12 min; store unpeeled	1 week	Breakfast, snacks, salad topping
Dal (pressure cooker)	2 cups dry lentils; triple quantities	4–5 days	Lunch, dinner with roti/rice
Roasted vegetables	3–4 types; toss oil+spices; 200°C 30 min	4 days	Side dishes, bowls, wraps
Paneer cubes (400g)	Cut and store, or marinate and bake	3–4 days	Tikka, bhurji, curry, snacks

Module 4 (CS_B2) Key Takeaways

- Meal planning is the single highest-leverage dietary habit — preparation beats willpower
- Fat loss: 300–500 kcal deficit + 2.0–2.4g/kg protein + high fibre for satiety
- Muscle building: 200–400 kcal surplus + 1.8–2.2g/kg protein + carbs to fuel training
- Indian cuisine is naturally adaptable — air frying, curd-based marinades, and vegetable-first plating reduce calories
- Vegan athletes must supplement B12, algae omega-3, and vitamin D3 without exception
- Sunday batch cooking (rice, protein, dal, vegetables) enables daily healthy eating with minimal weekday effort

1. Design a fat loss meal plan for a 65kg Indian female at 1600 kcal target.
2. What is the lean bulk surplus, and why is it preferable to a "dirty bulk" for body composition?
3. Name 4 nutrients at risk in a vegan diet and provide both food and supplement solutions for each.
4. Explain how Sunday batch cooking reduces decision fatigue and improves dietary adherence.
5. How does replacing full-fat coconut milk with light coconut milk in a curry reduce calories while maintaining satisfaction?